LIBRARIES OF THE FUTURE EXPO

Hon MEC SIBULELE NGONGO
Dept of Sport, Recreation, Arts and Culture

South African Library Week 2026
Provincial Celebrations
East London Convention Centre, KuGompo City -BCM.

"RECLAIMING KNOWLEDGE EMPOWERING FUTURES"

16-18 March 2026 Starting @ 08:30 Daily

Programme Day 1

TIME	ITEM	SPEAKER(S)
08:30 – 09:00	Briefing Session (parallel)	HOD: Ms. Gobozi-Nibe
08:30 – 09:00	Registration	
PROGRAMME DIRECTOR	Azola Vanda commonly known as **Ms. Vee** (Voice Lounge)	
	NATIONAL ANTHEM	**Ms. Makamba-** BCM District
09:05 – 09:15	Opening & Welcome Remarks	Mayor: Hon Cllr. Princess Faku
09:15 – 09:30	Setting of the tone & official opening the EXPO	Honourable MEC: Sibulele Ngongo
09:30 - 10:00	Official opening of the exhibition & walk about	Honourable MEC: Sibulele Ngongo
10:00 – 10:15	*Tea break*	
10:15 – 10:30	ON STAGE PERFORMANCE	
10:30 – 10:45	Broadband, Digitisation & Automation-Eastern Cape ICT Strategy	**Mr. Nation Madikiza** - OTP
10:45 – 11:00	National overview: on Libraries of the Future Plan	**Mr. Puleng Kekana** – DSAC
11:00 – 12:45	Panel Discussion "Libraries in a Digital Ag e"	**Mr. Charlie Molepo** LIASA President **Mr. Eddy Mabuza** Ndende Technologies **Mr. Phiwe Salukaza** na-MapheQ Mobile **Ms. Neesha Ramsumar** – UKS **Prof Jean Greyling**
12:45 – 13:00	Summation	**Mr Andile Magocoba** - UFH
13:00 – 14:00	*Lunch Break*	
14:00 – 14:15	Inclusive Library Services in the Digital World	**Ms. Nomonde Maqubela** – SALB
14:15 – 14:30	Leveraging Artificial Intelligence in research and library resources	**Mr. Lungile Mdanyana** – WSU
	Breakaway sessions	
14:45 – 16:30	Digital Literacy and Lifelong Learning" – Exploring programs that empower communities to develop digital skills.	**Session Chair** **Ms. Nokuthula Musa** – NLSA
14:45 – 16:30	"Libraries as Cultural and Community Hubs" – Showcasing libraries as spaces for local culture, storytelling, and community events.	**Session Chair** **Mr. Monwabisi Kobese** - DSRAC
16:30	Closing	Programme Director Announcements

Programme Day 2

TIME	ITEM	SPEAKERS
08:30 – 09:00	Registration	
09:00 – 09:05	Opening & Welcome	Programme Director: **Ms. Okuhle Thombe**
09:05 – 09:30	The Launch of the University of Fort Hare Digital Library "Preserving Our Past, Digitizing Our Future" Information Literacy for the Digital Age (IL4DAI)	**Ms. Londeka Dlamini** - UFH **Ms Esethu Dlabantu** - UFH
09:30 – 10:15	NWU Digital Transformation journey	**Dr. Sabelo Chizwina** - NWU **Mr. Cecil Gasa**
10:15 – 10:30	*Tea break*	
10:35 – 11:00	Guest Speaker: "Adoption of Artificial Intelligence Aided Open Sources Systems & Databases in Public Libraries in the Fifth Industrial Revolution"	**Prof. Mashilo Modiba** (UNISA)
11:00 – 12:45	Panel Discussion: Artificial Intelligence	**Mr. Lubabalo Dyantyi** - Deviare **Mr. Collin Mamdoo** - Vodacom **Ms. Madira Makhubela** - Sabinet **Mr. Jacques Swanepoel** - CSX **Mr. Marcus Maphile** - NLSA
12:45 – 13:00	Summation	**Chairperson EC Library Council:** **Mr. Mosuli Cwele**
13:00 – 14:00	*Lunch Break*	
14:00 – 14:20	Training the Transformers: Building AICompetencies for Librarians in the Global South.	**Ms. Sibongiseni Mrwashu -** University of Fort Hare
14:20 – 15:00	Lightbulb Learn Presentation	**Ms. Sarah Egerton-** Lightbulb/Telkom Foundation
15:00 – 15:30	E-Gov & Asset Management Solutions (GRAAP)	**Ms. Zodumo Ngqasa** - Boxfusion
15:30 – 15:45	City of Joburg eLearning platform	**Mr. Jeff Nyoka &** **Mr. Tebogo Msimang**
15:45 – 16:15	DREAM CITY PROJECT	**Mr. Mzwamadoda Mavimbela**
16:15	Closing Announcements	Programme Director

Programme Day 3

TIME	ITEM	SPEAKERS
08:30 – 09:00	Registration & Networking Tea	
09:05 – 09:10	Opening & Welcome	**Mr. Silk Damoyi**
09:15 – 09:50	Feedback from Commissions	**Ms. Nokuthula Musa &** **Mr. Monwabisi Kobese**
09:50- 10:00	ON STAGE PERFOMANCE	
10:00 – 11:00	Handover of Digital Equipment to Mdantsane NU14 and Mt Ayliff Library	Honourable MEC: Sibulele Ngongo
	Kirkwood Public Library Special Award for Winning LIASA Library of the Year	Honourable MEC: Sibulele Ngongo
11:00 – 11:15	Vote of Thanks	MAYOR
	RUNNING PARALLEL	
	TRAINING SESSIONS	
09:00 – 10:30	Building Strong Reading Communtiies: Strategy, Implementation & PIMS Reporting	**Ms. Linda Ntaka** - Librarian of the Year
10:45 – 13:00	Masterclass titled The Superhuman Librarian: AI, Knowledge and the Library of the Future	**Mr. Lubabalo Dyantyi** - Deviare
13:00-14:00	*Lunch Break*	

'A United, Active and Winning Province Through Sport, Recreation, Arts, Culture & Heritage'

Province of the EASTERN CAPE SPORT, RECREATION, ARTS & CULTURE
Province of the EASTERN CAPE EDUCATION
BUFFALO CITY METROPOLITAN MUNICIPALITY
NLSA National Library of South Africa
LIASA
HOME OF LEGENDS